

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cooler, sun and clouds, light wind, a shower is possible, high 52. **Tonight**, mainly clear, cool, breezy, low 36. **Tomorrow**, sunny, cool, high 53. Weather map is on Page A16.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



DANIELE VOLPE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Risking It All for a Passport
Diana Acosta Verde entered the United States at six months pregnant to ensure her child’s citizenship in a safe country. Page A12.

Democrats Go On G.O.P. Turf With Tax Cuts

By ANDREW DUEHREN

Typically, a bill like the one Senator Chris Van Hollen, a Maryland Democrat, introduced last month would not make much of a splash. It was, after all, a tax proposal that is not going anywhere while President Trump remains in office, the type of idea that is often only greeted by self-congratulatory news releases. But Mr. Van Hollen’s legislation went viral, at least by the perhaps modest standards of Washington tax developments.

The bill was the subject of extensive news coverage even before it was formally introduced, and lawmakers from the party’s moderate and progressive wings, including Senator Bernie Sanders, a Vermont independent, endorsed it. Democratic policy experts, meanwhile, unleashed such intense and insistent criticism of Mr. Van Hollen’s plan that some of them only half-joked that the party was in the midst of a “wonk revolt.”

The reason for the attention, ire and, admittedly, articles like this one was that Mr. Van Hollen was proposing a broad tax cut. His bill would exempt many working-class Americans from paying any federal income tax, while cutting taxes for individuals making up to \$80,500 and married couples earning up to \$161,000. Mr. Van Hollen would cover the \$1.6 trillion cost of these cuts by raising taxes on people making more than \$1 million a year.

And he’s not alone: Other Democrats — including Senator Cory Booker of New Jersey and candidates in races across the country — have put forward their own plans for wide-ranging tax cuts.

“The fundamental idea is if you’re working paycheck to paycheck and earning enough just to make ends meet, you should be able to keep more of what you earn,” Mr. Van Hollen said in an interview.

To the party’s caste of economists, tax lawyers and think tank analysts, substantially raising taxes on millionaires is all well and good. Their main problem is with dedicating that potential revenue to another round of tax cuts, rather than reversing Mr. Trump’s cuts to programs like food stamps or Medicaid — or otherwise expanding the social safety net. Tax

Continued on Page A18

Syrians, Needing U.S. Help, Invoke Trump Name

By ERIC LIPTON

Last summer, Representative Joe Wilson, Republican of South Carolina, sat in his Capitol Hill office in rapt attention as Middle Eastern investors laid out their plans in a video call to develop coastal property in Syria.

A cruise ship port. A polo club. A Bugatti car showroom. A world-class golf course. All in a country that had just recently been torn apart by civil war.

Nor was this everything. While Mohamad Al-Khayyat, a powerful Syrian-born businessman, was pitching the proposal, his brothers were winning more than \$12 billion in government-sponsored contracts to rebuild a wide swath of the devastated Syrian economy.

There was a hitch, though. The Khayyats needed a big favor from Congress with the support of President Trump: the permanent lifting of crippling sanctions imposed on Syria before the fall of President Bashar al-Assad in late 2024.

That is when Mr. Wilson, himself a former real estate lawyer and proponent of the sanctions repeal, offered a tactical suggestion. “I know how to get the president’s attention,” Mr. Wilson said. “Make it a Trump National Golf Course in Syria.”

Mohamad Al-Khayyat was already a step ahead. He said he had planned to propose a Trump-branded resort.

Continued on Page A6



LAURA BOUSHNAK FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Moutaz and Ramez Al-Khayyat, at their Qatar offices, have contracts to rebuild Syria’s economy.

Justice Dept. Installs Trump Loyalist to Head Effort to Paint Foes as Conspirators

By CHARLIE SAVAGE and ALAN FEUER

WASHINGTON — As a sprawling inquiry expands into whether former federal officials committed crimes in investigating President Trump, two unusual factors could ease the way toward securing the indictments he craves.

A former lawyer for Mr. Trump’s campaign, Joseph diGenova, has been selected to lead the inquiry after a career prosecutor in Miami was removed from that post this past week, a senior law enforcement official said on Saturday.

And at least part of the investigation appears to be using a grand jury based in Fort Pierce, Fla., overseen by a federal judge,

Aileen M. Cannon, who issued rulings favorable to Mr. Trump during the classified documents case against him, the official added. Mr. diGenova is expected to split his time between Miami and Fort Pierce.

Together, the moves show how the Justice Department under Mr. Trump’s control has been willing to embrace politically charged

Nuclear Fears Rise for Site Deep in Iranian Mountain

Trump Is Urged to Move on Facility Thought to Be Beyond the Reach of Bombs

By MICHAEL CROWLEY

WASHINGTON — Over the past year, U.S. airstrikes have crippled Iran’s nuclear program. Several Iranian nuclear facilities lie in ruins. And Iran’s stockpile of highly enriched uranium — “nuclear dust,” as President Trump calls it — is thought to be deeply buried under rubble.

But even after a U.S. bombing raid last June and more than five weeks of attacks on Iran since February, one suspected nuclear site remains untouched. Experts say the underground facility, known as Pickaxe Mountain, is so deep that it may lie beyond the reach of America’s most powerful bunker-buster bombs.

Experts do not believe the facility is yet complete. But they fear that in the future, Pickaxe Mountain could provide Iran a venue for producing nuclear weapons that is impervious to aerial attack.

As Mr. Trump bombed the country in recent weeks, some Iran hawks pressed him to consider sending Special Forces on a risky ground mission to destroy the facility with planted high explosives. One White House ally recently proposed injecting its halls with chemical contaminants.

Other experts who favor dialogue over conflict call those ideas far-fetched and say that Pickaxe Mountain illustrates the impossibility of relying on force alone to prevent Iran from acquiring a nuclear bomb.

The immediate concern of the United States’ dealings with Iran is the Strait of Hormuz, the vital waterway for one-fifth of the world’s oil. After declaring it open on Friday, Iran reversed course the next day, saying it would continue to throttle traffic until the United States ended its own naval blockade of Iranian ships.

Should talks between the two countries resume in earnest, the major focus will be the future of Iran’s nuclear program. And experts inside and outside the American government believe that any deal must ensure that Pickaxe Mountain is permanently shut down.

Little is known about Pickaxe Mountain, referred to locally as Kuh-e Kolang Gaz La. But in the fall, satellite images revealed that Iran had advanced construction at the site soon after U.S. forces disabled the country’s three main nuclear facilities in June.

Mr. Trump cited that activity in an April address as a reason for launching war with Iran. After the three sites were hit, he said, Iran’s leaders “sought to rebuild their nuclear program at a totally different location, making clear they had no intention of abandoning their pursuit of nuclear weapons.”

Analysts said Mr. Trump was clearly referring to Pickaxe Mountain.

One of the sites targeted by Operation Midnight Hammer in June was Iran’s mountainside uranium enrichment facility at Fordo, which the United States struck with 30,000-pound bombs known as Massive Ordnance Penetrators designed specifically for that mission.

But even those fearsome bombs might not be able to reach Pickaxe Mountain’s interior chambers, which are about 2,000 feet deeper under granite than Fordo, according to the Institute for Science and International Security.

“Pickaxe Mountain is deeper and bigger and more fortified than Fordo,” said Blaise Misztal, the vice president for policy at the Jewish Institute for National Security of America, or JINSA, a Washington research organization.

Continued on Page A8

U.S. Navy Strikes Iranian Ship As Nations Quarrel Over Talks

This article is by Tyler Pager, Shirin Hakim and Sanam Mahoozi.

A U.S. Navy destroyer on Sunday attacked and seized an Iranian cargo ship that defied an American blockade of Iran’s ports, President Trump said, posing a fresh threat to the fragile cease-fire that is set to expire this week.

Mr. Trump announced the attack hours after a White House official said the U.S. was dispatching a high-level delegation including Vice President JD Vance to peace talks in Pakistan, although the Iranian state media said Tehran had not agreed to a meeting.

The guided missile destroyer U.S.S. Spruance fired on the cargo vessel Touska, Mr. Trump said on Truth Social, “blowing a hole” in its engine room before Marines took possession of the vessel. The president said the ship was under U.S. sanctions because of a “history of illegal activity” and that U.S. forces were “seeing what’s on board!”

Mr. Trump did not say whether there had been any casualties.

Attack Follows Denial by Tehran It Agreed to Meet in Pakistan

Iran’s semiofficial Mehr news agency did not acknowledge the seizure of a ship. It reported that U.S. forces had fired on an Iranian merchant vessel, but said naval units from Iran’s Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps had forced the Americans to retreat.

U.S. Central Command said in a statement that a U.S. Navy destroyer repeatedly warned the Iranian-flagged cargo ship to stop over a six-hour period on Sunday before disabling the vessel to allow helicopter-borne Marines to board and seize it.

The Touska had departed from Malaysia with cargo and crossed the U.S. blockade line before it was intercepted, according to Tanker-Trackers.com, a company that monitors global oil shipments.

Continued on Page A8



INTERNATIONAL A4-10
Stuck Whale Charms Germany
A month of efforts to help a stranded humpback have culminated in spectacle, but no success. PAGE A9

Joining a Handful of Survivors
Hundreds of migrants, including Rohingya refugees, are feared dead after a boat to Malaysia overturned. PAGE A4

NATIONAL A11-19
Seeking a Cure for Politics
Dozens of Democratic doctors are running for office, some spurred by their opposition to Robert F. Kennedy Jr. and his anti-vaccine stance. PAGE A11

Eight Children Are Killed
The gunman, who shot 10 people in Shreveport, La., was killed by the police, the authorities said. PAGE A17

BUSINESS B1-8
Front-Facing Chief Executives
Most C.E.O.s are unidentifiable to customers. Stepping into the limelight can bring rewards and risks. PAGE B1



ARTS C1-6
An Opera About Terrorism
The director Luca Guadagnino is staging John Adams’s “The Death of Klinghoffer,” above, in Italy. PAGE C1

New Path to Venice Biennale
The Trump administration’s process for choosing an artist to represent the U.S. at the event has drawn criticism. PAGE C1

SPORTS D1-7
Behind the Frozen Yogurt Ads
Crémilly bought splashy sponsorship rights in M.L.B. ballparks. But employees say the company was a con, and two teams are now suing them for nonpayment. PAGE D1

Jettisoning a Distraction
The Giants cut ties with the defensive star Dexter Lawrence, trading him to the Bengals for the 10th pick in this year’s N.F.L. draft. But the team now has a void to fill. PAGE D6

OPINION A20-21
M. Gessen PAGE A20



OBITUARIES D8
Portrayer of U.S. Divisions
Celeste Dupuy-Spencer, with works like “Don’t You See That I Am Burning,” about the Jan. 6 riots, was known for “painting the news.” She was 46.



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